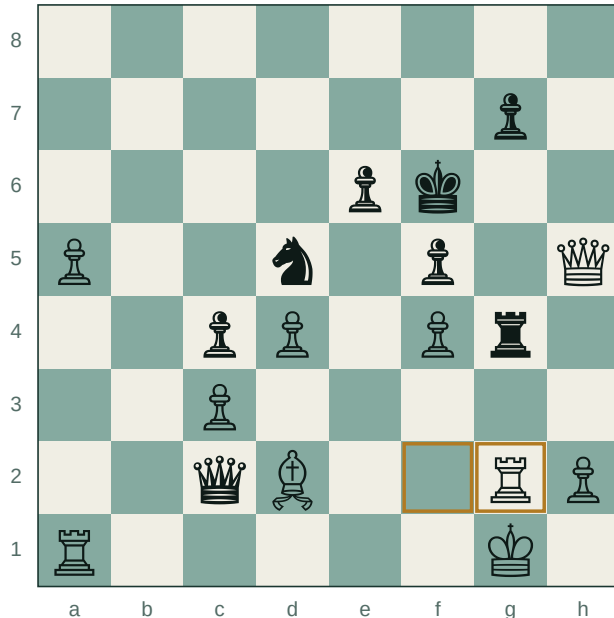


Pins and pressure: Black, move 33

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 33.Rxg2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33...Rxg2+ 34. Kxg2 Nxf4+ 35. Kg1 Nxh5

33...Rxg2+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From g2 it attacks king on g1 and bishop on d2. Recorded reply: **34.Kxg2**.

34...Nxf4+ Check restricts White to 6 legal replies here. From f4 it attacks king on g2 and queen on h5. Recorded reply: **35.Kg1**.

35...Nxh5 The knight captures the queen on h5.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 16 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +10. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +10: the balance goes from -6 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g1. Absolute pin: rook on g2.